Indigenous Peoples of Canada

Target Audience: B1+ / B2
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach

Lesson Objectives:

- Educational: Understand the history of Indigenous peoples in Canada (First Nations, Inuit, Métis) and the modern concept of "Reconciliation".
- Linguistic: Practice vocabulary related to history and social justice (e.g., *indigenous, treaty, residential school, reconciliation, heritage*).
- Socio-cultural: Develop empathy and cultural respect by analyzing historical injustices and discussing how modern societies can heal historical trauma (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate visual literacy and spark curiosity.	5 min	Teacher shows two photos on the screen: 1. A traditional Inuit person in a kayak (historical). 2. A modern Indigenous teenager with a smartphone (present). Ask: *"What do you see? What is the difference between these two photos? Do Indigenous people only live in the past?"*	Pictures of historical and modern Indigenous people.
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary for the lesson.	7 min	Match words with definitions: *indigenous, treaty, residential school, reconciliation, heritage.*	Presentation slide
Reading	Develop reading skills for chronological understanding.	10 min	Students read a short text (Timeline style) about the history of Indigenous peoples in Canada. They put the events in the correct order on a timeline.	Text and Timeline Residential School Timeline - NCTR , BBC NEWS | Americas | Legacy of

				Canada's residential schools , Residential Schools in Canada (Plain-Language Summary) | The Canadian Encyclopedia
Post-Reading	Develop critical thinking and empathy.	8 min	Students read 3 short quotes from Indigenous leaders or Canadian government officials about "Reconciliation". They discuss: *"What does 'reconciliation' mean in this context? Why is it important?"*	Quotes
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop critical thinking through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	15 min	Group work. Students are museum curators. They must create a concept for an exhibit about "Reconciliation" in Canada. They must write a title for the exhibit and 3 rules for visitors (what they should think about while looking at the exhibit). Task 2: Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"Does your country have indigenous or minority groups that suffered in the past? How does your country remember them?"*	A4 paper for brainstorming, markers
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	Reflection: *"Why is it important to learn about the history of indigenous people?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"Why is 'reconciliation' a difficult but important*	Notebooks

			process for any country?"	

Word	Letter	Definition
1. Indigenous	[ ]	A. A formal agreement or treaty between two groups (often about land or peace).
2. Treaty	[ ]	B. The process of making peace and building a good relationship again after a conflict.
3. Residential school	[ ]	C. The traditions, languages, and culture passed down from generation to generation.
4. Reconciliation	[ ]	D. People who are the original inhabitants of a land (native people).
5. Heritage	[ ]	E. A school where Indigenous children were forced to live and were separated from their families (a dark part of Canadian history).

1. D
2. A
3. E
4. B
5. C

Long before Europeans arrived, Indigenous peoples (First Nations, Inuit, and Métis) lived in North America. They had complex societies, languages, and cultures.

In the 17th and 18th centuries, European settlers arrived. They made treaties with Indigenous peoples, promising land and resources. However, many of these promises were broken.

From the 1870s to the 1990s, the Canadian government forced Indigenous children to attend residential schools. They were separated from their families, forced to speak English or French, and lost their heritage. This caused deep trauma.

In 2008, the Canadian government officially apologized for the residential school system. Today, the country is working on reconciliation—trying to heal the relationship with Indigenous communities.

Task: Read the text and put the events in the correct order from 1 (first) to 4 (last).

[ ] The Canadian government apologized for residential schools.
[ ] European settlers arrived and made treaties.
[ ] Indigenous peoples lived in North America.
[ ] Children were forced to attend residential schools.

Quote Analysis

Task: Read these quotes about "Reconciliation" and discuss the questions.

Quote 1: *"Reconciliation is not about the past. It is about the future."* — Indigenous leader.

Quote 2: *"We must learn the truth before we can heal."* — Canadian politician.

Quote 3: *"Our heritage is not dead. It is alive in our youth."* — Inuit artist.

Discussion Questions:

1. What does "reconciliation" mean in these quotes?
2. Why is it important to learn the "truth" about history?
3. How do you think a country can heal historical trauma?

Discuss the questions in pairs or small groups:

1. Does your country have indigenous or minority groups that suffered in the past?
2. How does your country remember or teach about them?
3. What can we learn from Canada's experience with reconciliation?